

STAGE FOUR • MINDSET, PRODUCTIVITY & HABITS

# FIRSTS

---

## GROUP VERSIONS OF KEY EXERCISES

*Live, group-adapted versions of the FIRSTS that benefit most from interaction*

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

## FIRSTS • Group Versions of Key Exercises

*Stage Four • Mindset, Productivity & Habits*

### PURPOSE

Stage Four's twenty-five FIRSTS are largely written as solo, private habits: your own confidence routine, your own KPI tracker, your own reflection journal. That's appropriate for most of them — mindset and productivity systems are inherently personal. But a handful genuinely strengthen when done or tested alongside other people, particularly the ones where accountability, outside perspective, or shared vulnerability changes the outcome.

This document adapts seven FIRSTS spanning both of this stage's source categories (Mindset, Productivity & Habits, and Extra Edge / Standout Factor) into pair, small-group, or full-room formats. As always, these are additions, not replacements — participants complete their own individual work first, and the group version deepens or stress-tests it.

Each entry includes a suggested format, the extra time it adds beyond the solo version, numbered steps you can read almost verbatim to a group, and a short note on why the live version specifically matters for that FIRST.

## The Seven Adapted Exercises

---

### FIRST E1

#### Confidence Routine — Live Group Practice

TIME: +10 min beyond solo drafting

1. After each person drafts their 3-part routine (posture, breath, mental cue) individually, everyone stands up together.
2. On a facilitator count of three, the whole room runs their routine simultaneously, out loud where relevant.
3. Quick debrief: did doing it alongside other people feel different from doing it alone? Easier or harder to commit fully?

##### FACILITATOR NOTE

*Doing a slightly vulnerable physical routine as a group, all at once, removes the self-consciousness of being the only one doing something unusual — which is often the real barrier to actually using a confidence routine in real life.*

### FIRST E4

#### Resilience Drill — Peer-Guided Debrief

TIME: +15 min beyond solo reflection

1. Pairs. Partner A shares a recent, real, low-stakes setback (not the most painful one they have — something manageable to share).
2. Partner B asks the drill's three questions directly, out loud, one at a time, and listens to the real answers rather than just prompting silently.
3. Swap roles.

##### FACILITATOR NOTE

*Being asked the resilience questions by another person, rather than just journaling them alone, makes it harder to skip past a genuinely honest answer — a partner's follow-up ("wait, say more about that") often gets further than solo reflection does.*

### FIRST E8

#### Personal KPI Tracker — Peer Sanity-Check

TIME: +10 min beyond solo drafting

1. After each person drafts their 3–5 KPIs individually, pairs swap lists.
2. Partner reviews: does this set of numbers actually reflect meaningful progress, or does it measure activity that doesn't matter (e.g., "number of job boards checked")?
3. Each person revises at least one KPI based on their partner's honest reaction.

##### FACILITATOR NOTE

*It's easy to accidentally track something that feels productive but doesn't actually predict a real*

*outcome. An outside read catches vanity metrics that the person who wrote them is too close to see.*

#### FIRST E12

### Accountability Partner — Live Matching & Commitment

TIME: +15 min beyond framing

1. Rather than messaging someone outside the session, have participants pair up with someone else in the room right now.
2. Each pair agrees on a specific weekly check-in format (day, time, medium) on the spot.
3. Both people write the commitment down and exchange contact information before leaving the room.

#### FACILITATOR NOTE

*Accountability partnerships proposed “I’ll message someone later” have a much higher failure rate than ones locked in live, in the room, with a specific first check-in already scheduled.*

#### FIRST E17

### Goal Visualization Exercise — Guided Group Visualization

TIME: +10 min beyond individual writing

1. Dim lights if possible. Facilitator reads a slow, general prompt aloud (“imagine the day you accept an offer — where are you, what does the message say, who do you tell first”) while everyone closes their eyes.
2. After 3–4 minutes of guided silence, everyone opens their eyes and immediately writes three concrete details without discussing yet.
3. Optional: 1–2 volunteers share one detail with the group.

#### FACILITATOR NOTE

*A facilitator-guided group visualization tends to go deeper than a solo written prompt, since the shared silence and pacing removes the temptation to rush through it.*

#### FIRST F1

### Side Project — Idea Speed-Round

TIME: +15 min beyond solo brainstorming

1. Each person writes down their side project idea on a card or shared doc.
2. Rotate in small groups of 3–4: each person pitches their idea in 60 seconds, group gives one quick reaction (“could finish in a month” / “might be too big” / “genuinely interesting”).
3. Each person leaves with either validation or one honest scope concern to address.

#### FACILITATOR NOTE

*Side projects most commonly fail by being scoped too large. A quick outside gut-check catches an overambitious idea before real time gets invested in it.*

FIRST F5

## Thought Leadership Post — Opinion Roundtable

TIME: +15 min beyond solo drafting

1. Each person states their genuine opinion in one sentence to the group.
2. Facilitator picks 2–3 opinions that have some genuine disagreement or tension between them and opens brief, respectful discussion.
3. Everyone revises their original opinion statement based on what surfaced, sharpening it into something more specific or defensible.

### FACILITATOR NOTE

*A genuine opinion sharpens fastest when it's actually tested against pushback, even briefly — solo drafting alone often produces something safer and vaguer than a real, defensible take.*